Part B: Trading diary

ETFs Price Movement 2nd– 20th March

Portfolio : MK_318 created on 2nd March

				Current						Cost				
	Security	ID	Position	Price	PCS	FX Rate	Principal	Accrued	Market Val	Price	FX Rate	Principal	Accrued	Cost Val
	<Search>													
	Totals						164,825,500.00	0.00	164,825,500.00			156,572,000.00	0.00	156,572,000
	Cash		0.0000											
1)	BSOL US	BSOL	4,600,000.(	11.91	EXCH	1.00000	54,786,000.00		54,786,000.00	11.32	1.00000	52,072,000.00		52,072,000.(
2)	ETHA US	ETHA	3,500,000.(	16.10	EXCH	1.00000	56,350,000.00		56,350,000.00	14.93	1.00000	52,255,000.00		52,255,000.(
3)	IBIT US	IBIT	1,350,000.(	39.77	EXCH	1.00000	53,689,500.00		53,689,500.00	38.70	1.00000	52,245,000.00		52,245,000.(
4)														

Figure 4: ETF Portfolio from 6th – 20th March, increases from 156.6 million to $164.8 million with ETHA outperforming ($56 million)

i. Bitcoin Price Movement

The 2-20 March P&L was driven by geopolitical energy shock and later, due to capital rotation within crypto-assets. Initially, Bitcoin prices dropped in the Western market, wiping out $128 billion in total crypto market cap, but inside Iran, cryptocurrency exchange surged by 700% (Carter, 2026). As indicated by Figure 2, Bitcoin price decreases initially but after 9th March increases by 13.05%, and moves closely with gold, with a 0.94 daily correlation (Bloomberg, 2026). This divergence from the S&P 500 indicates that investors were hedging geopolitical inflation risk rather than expressing risk-on sentiment (Reuters, 2026). This pattern mirrors earlier conflict episodes, as illustrated in Figure 3, during the October 2023 Israel-Hamas escalation, BTC rose 35.75% over 30 days as a "digital gold" hedge. Similarly, the 2020 U.S.-Iran standoff saw BTC up 37.83% ($2,624 increase) in 30 days (see Figure 4), which Iran retaliated by striking military airbases in Iraq (Al Jazeera, 2020). Moreover, with oil-driven inflation fear highlighted by Goldman Sachs economist that " a sustained 10% rise in the oil price lifts CPI by 28 basis points" (Reuters, 2026), strengthening incentives that geopolitical shocks increasingly trigger "digital dollarisation". This is consistent with the IMF (2023) evidence that crypto adoption rises in countries of weak governance and geopolitical instability, explaining the 700% bitcoin activity surge in Iran.

Figure 5: Bitcoin USD with S&P500 and Gold

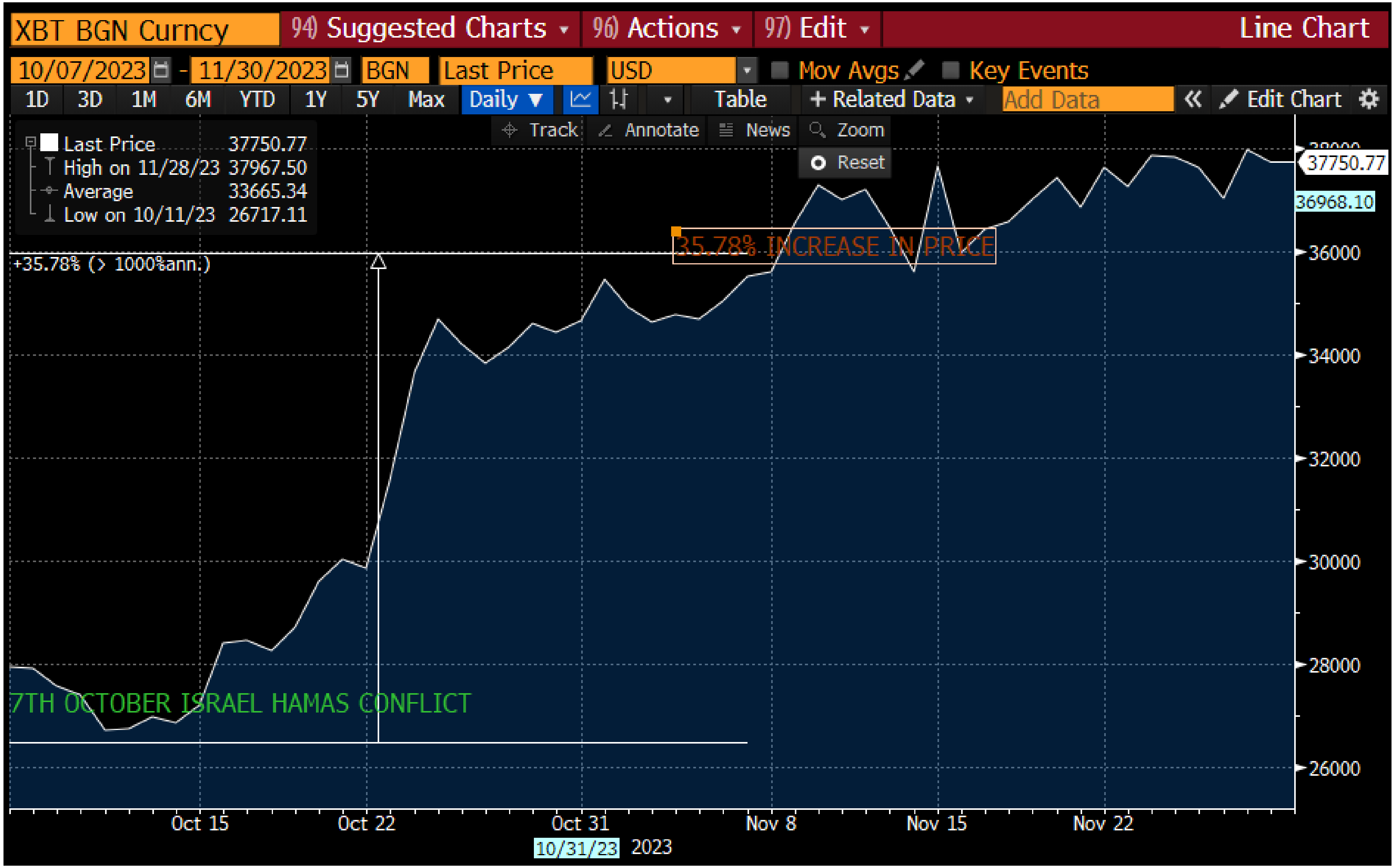

Figure 6: Bitcoin Price from 7th October 2023 – 7th November 2023 – Israel-Hamas War

Figure 7: Bitcoin 30-day rally up from 3rd January 2020 – 3rd February 2020, killing of IRGC Commander Qassem Soleimani

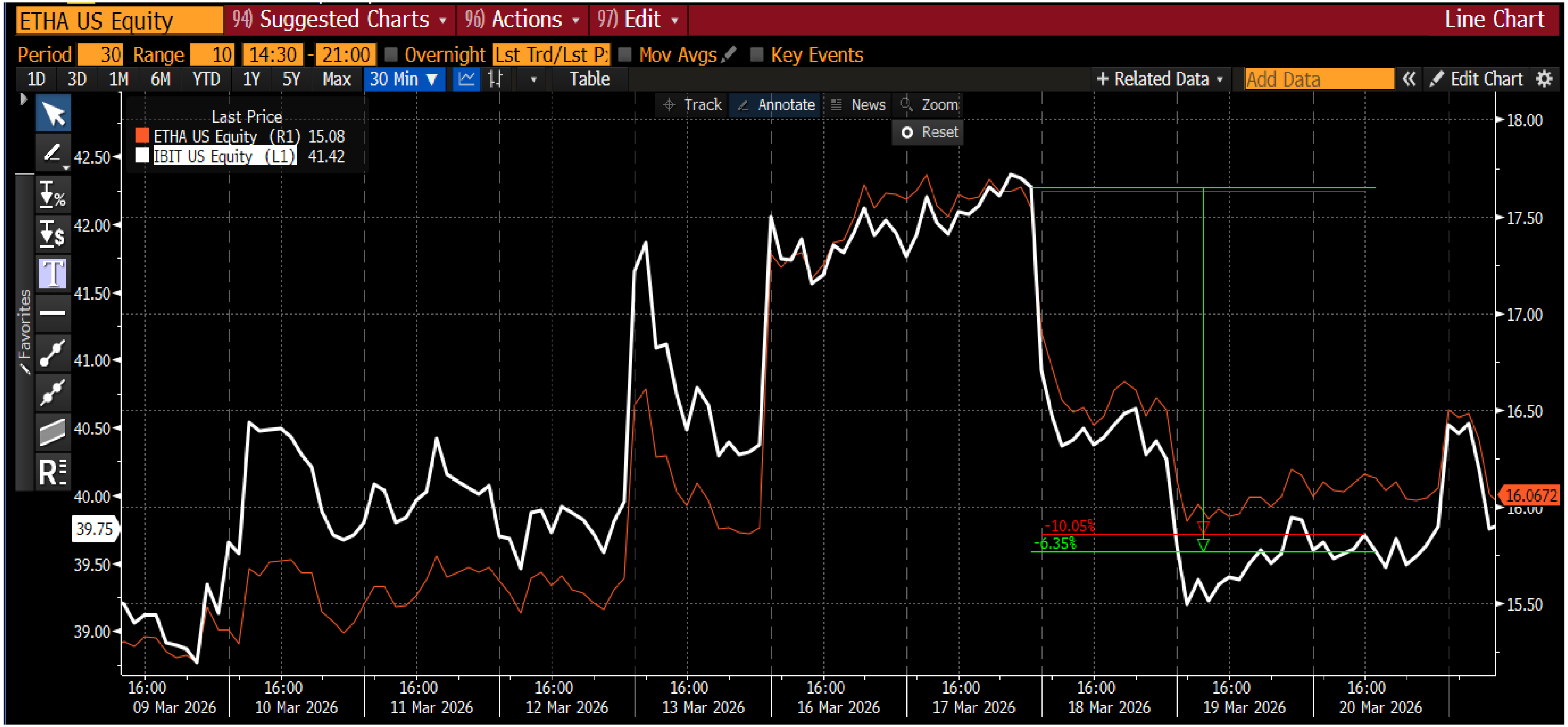

Figure 8: ETHA and IBIT Price Comparison

However, after 17th March, IBIT and ETHA dropped significantly, as illustrated by Figure 5, due to the deterioration of diplomatic challenges after the assassination of the IRGC commander Ali Larjani (CNN, 2026; Iqbal, 2026; Reuter, 2026). This broke the safe-haven correlation of Bitcoin and Ethereum customed by outflows (Figures 6 & 7). Moreover, traditional hedging assets, Gold and Silver, also saw a sharp decline, highlighted in Figures 8 and 9. The outperformance of ETHA in later days illustrated the capital rotation from IBIT to ETHA.

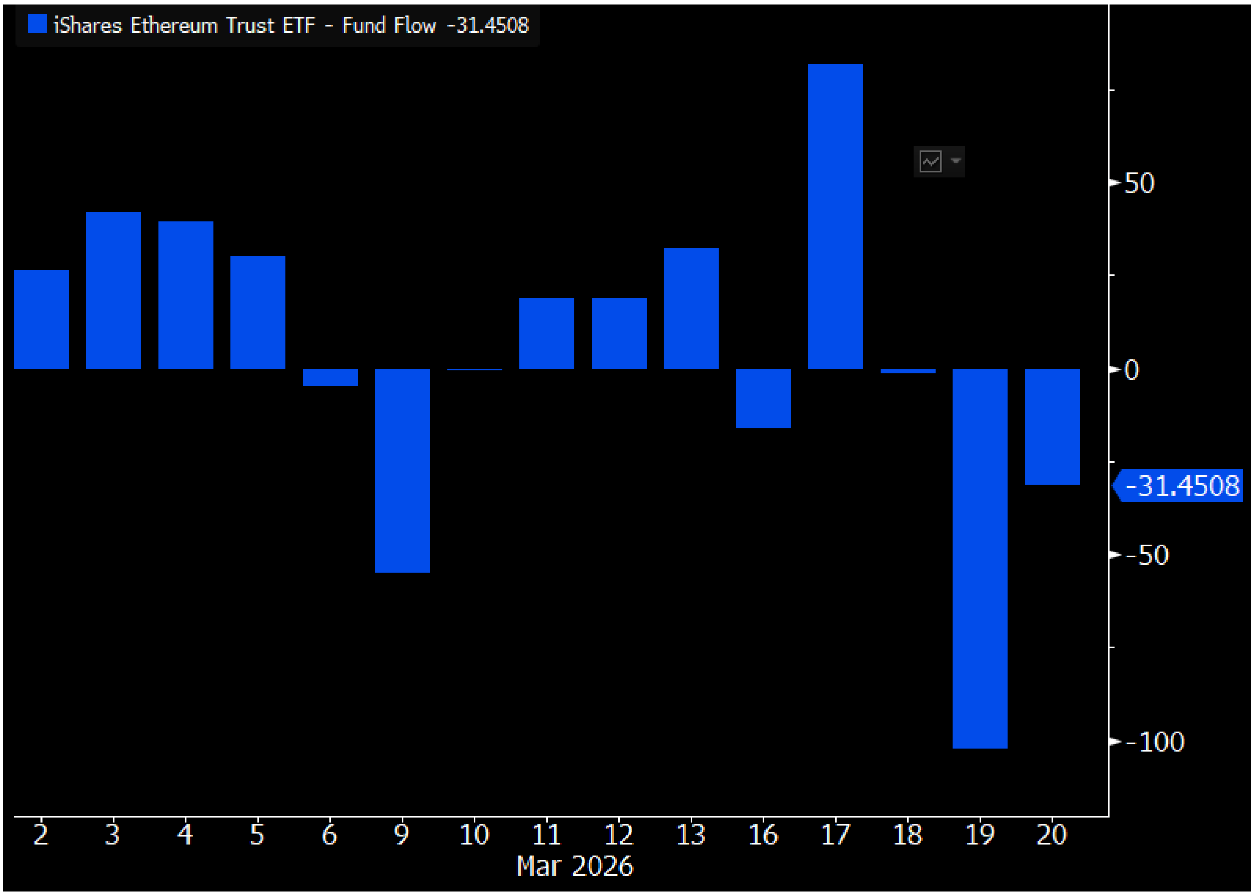

Figure 9: BlackRock ETHA ETF Flow Bar Chart

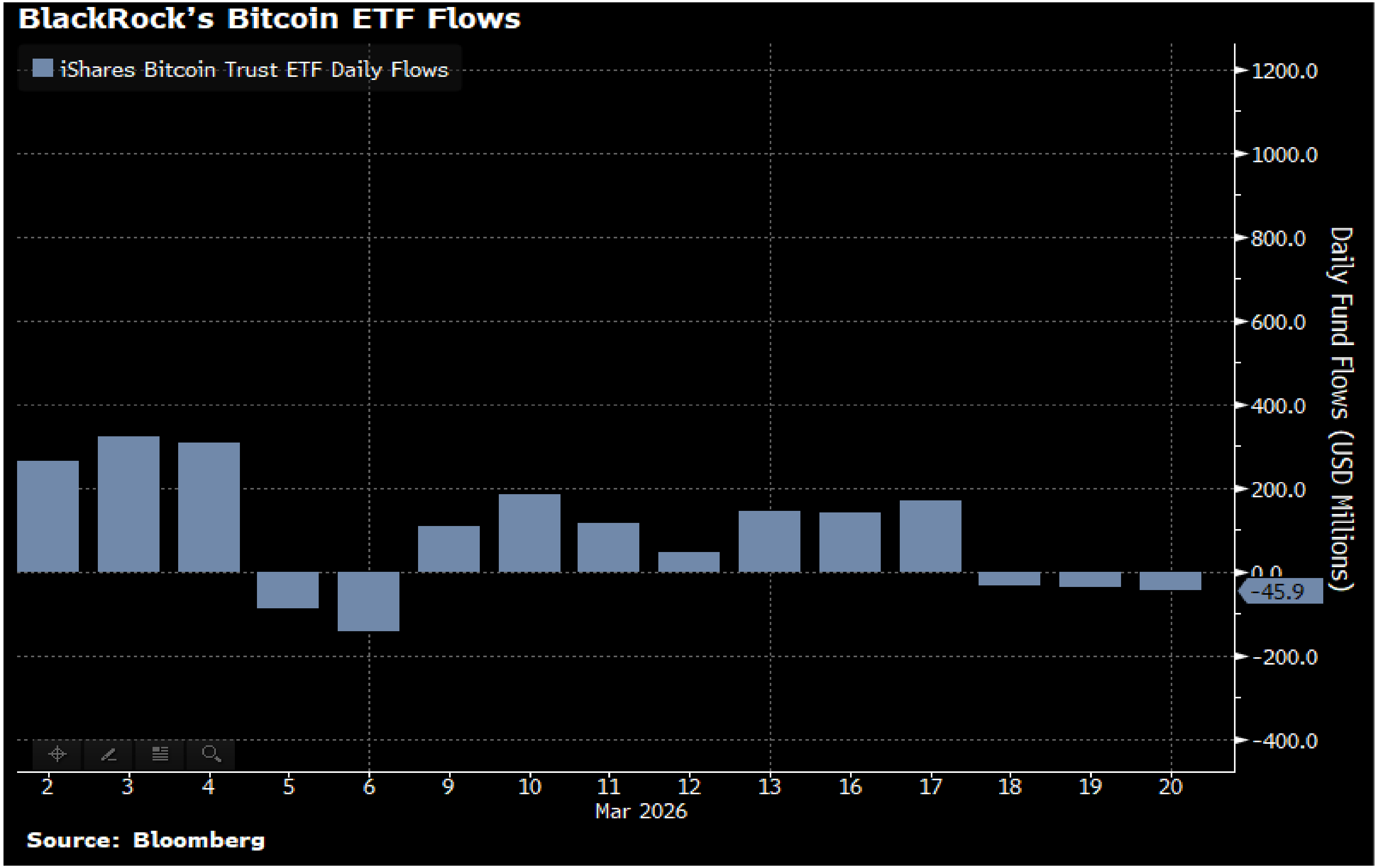

Figure 10: BlackRock IBIT Flow Chart

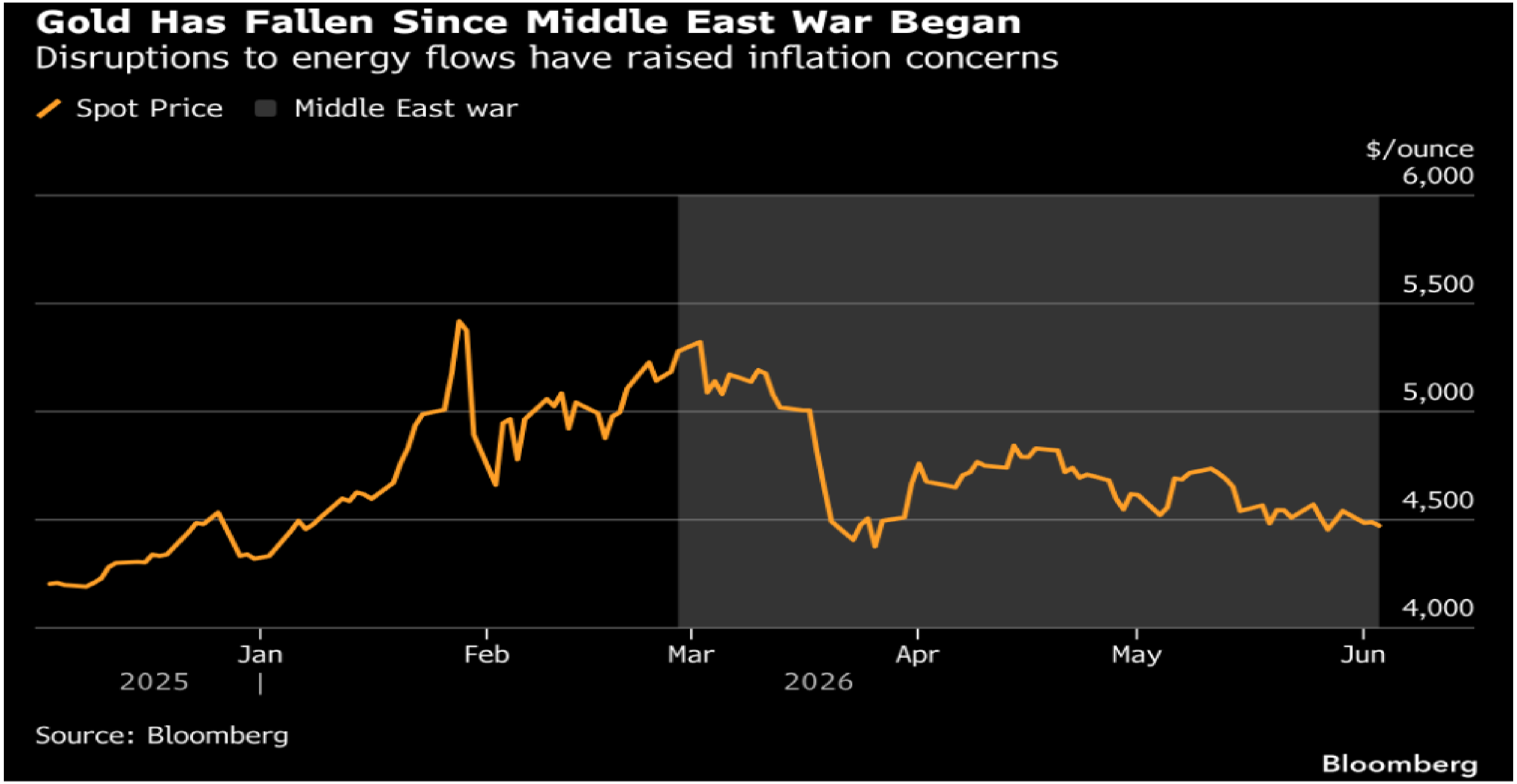

Figure 11: Gold Price Trend over the Middle East War Period

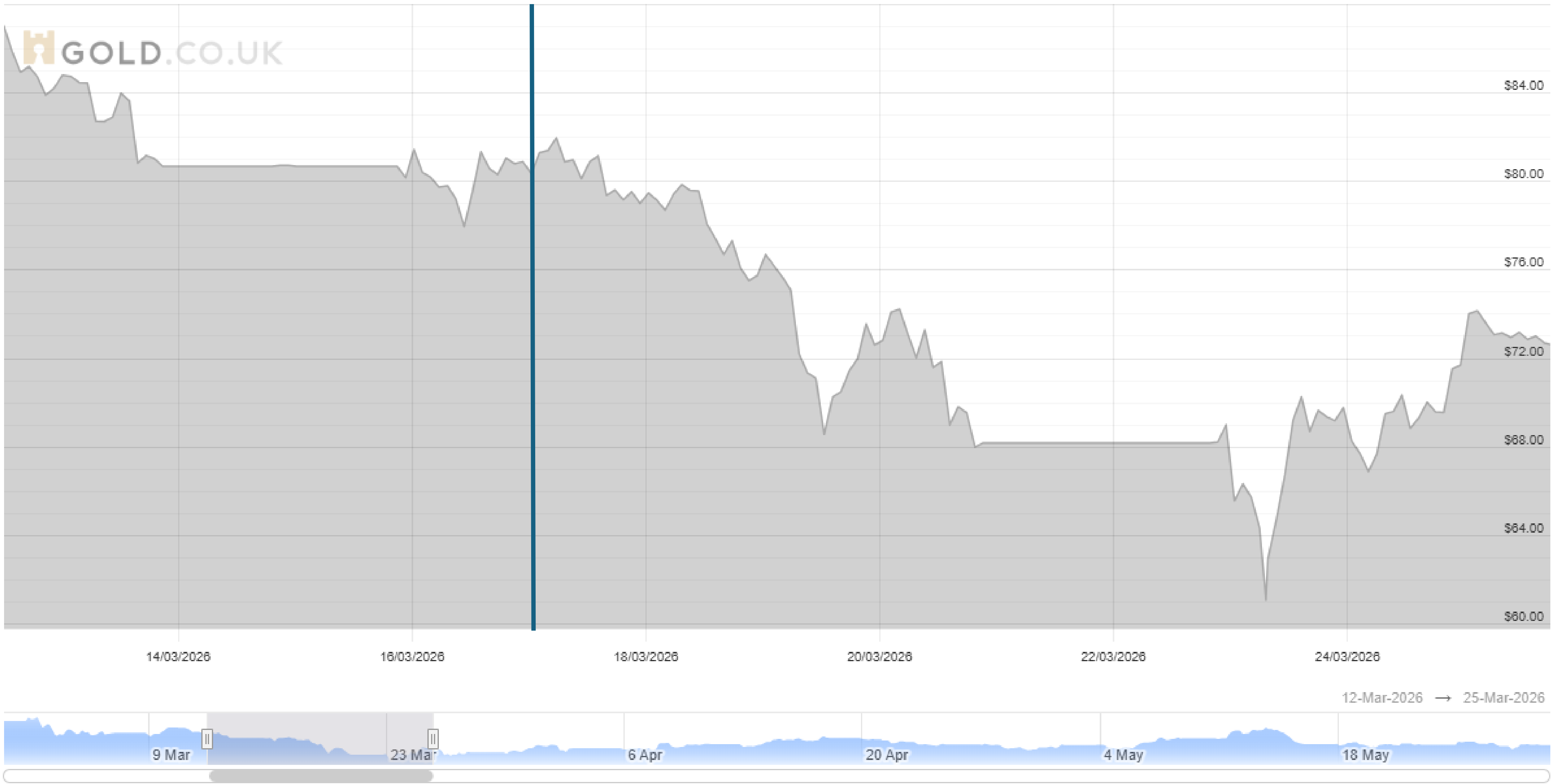

Figure 12: : Silver ounce price (USD) over 17th – 20th March   SOURCE: Gold.co.uk

ii. Ethereum and Solana Price Movement

Ethereum and Solana also rallied after the start of the conflict. Ethereum's uptake was due to institutional inflows. BitMine Immersion Technologies bought 60,999 ETHER, holding 4.6 million ETH in treasury on 15th March (Sandor and Reback, 2026). Figure 11 illustrates Ethereum outperforming the S&P500 after the 15th, continuing with the crypto asset serving as an alternative "digital dollar" during the time of higher political and economic uncertainty. Ethereum's resilience aligns with the BIS report (Auer et al, 2022) evidence that large-cap crypto assets increasingly decouple from high-beta altcoins during macro-financial stress, reflecting deeper liquidity and institutional participation.

In comparison, Solana outperforms ETHA till 15th March but falls in later days, suggesting short-term speculative momentum (see Figure 10). The decline in Solana is due to its low network activity (See Figure 12), suggesting SOL behaved more like a high-beta risk asset rather than a defensive or safe-haven asset, unlike ETHA & IBIT. This is consistent with the ECB (2023) evidence that many altcoins behave as speculative high-beta assets.

Overall, Ethereum benefits from a stronger store-of-value narrative and broader institutional integration, allowing it to attract defensive flows, while Solana's performance remains tied to speculative momentum and network-driven volatility (See Figure 12).

Figure 13: ETHA, BSOL and IBIT Price Comparison

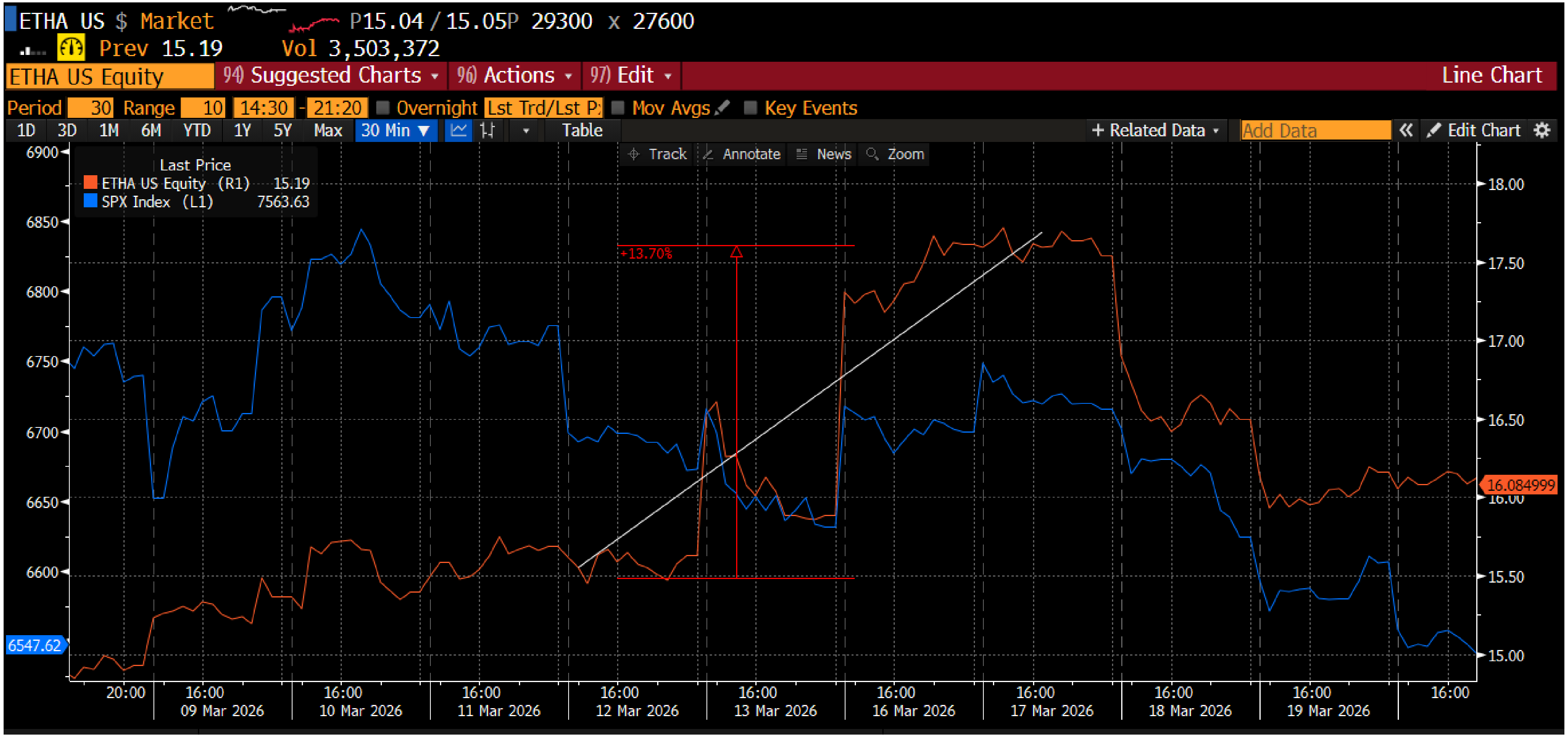

Figure 14: ETHA Performance compared to S&P500 Index

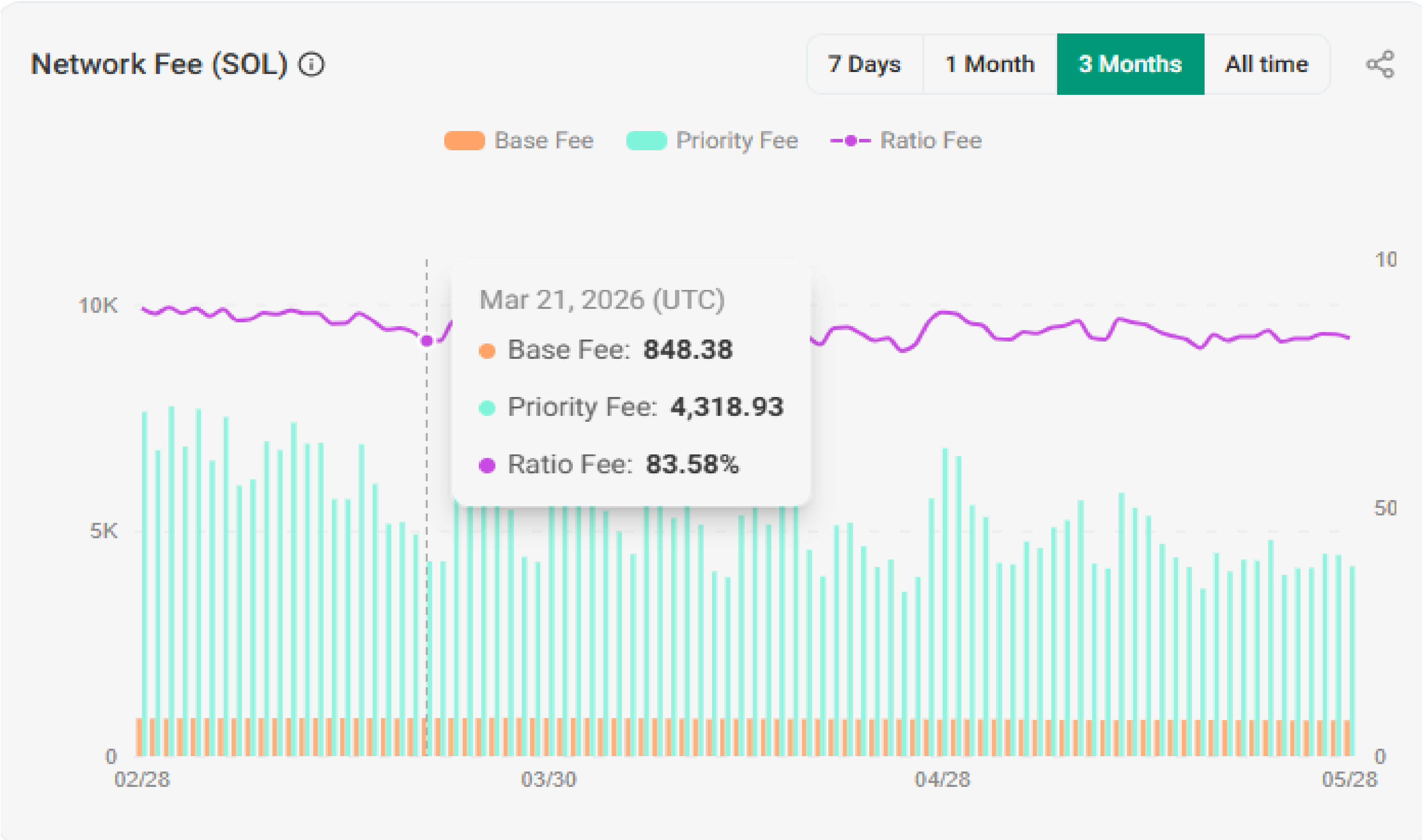

Figure 15: Solana Network Fees

ETFs Price Movement 21st March -1st May

Portfolio

							Current				Cost				
	Security	ID	Position	Price	PCS	FX Rate	Principal	Accrued	Market Val	Price	FX Rate	Principal	Accrued	Cost Val	Cost Date
	<Search>														
	Totals						173,030,500.00	0.00	173,030,500.00			164,825,500.00	0.00	164,825,500	
	Cash		0.0000												
11	BSOL US	BSOL	4,600,000.(	11.31	EXCH	1.00000	52,026,000.00		52,026,000.00	11.91	1.00000	54,786,000.00		54,786,000.(	02/27/26
12	ETHA US	ETHA	3,500,000.(	17.42	EXCH	1.00000	60,970,000.00		60,970,000.00	16.10	1.00000	56,350,000.00		56,350,000.(	02/27/26
13	IBIT US	IBIT	1,350,000.(	44.47	EXCH	1.00000	60,034,500.00		60,034,500.00	39.77	1.00000	53,689,500.00		53,689,500.(	02/27/26
14															

Figure 16: : Portfolio P&L from 20th March – 1st May, increases from $164.8 million to $173 with ETHA and IBIT outperforming ($60 million)

Figure 17:IBIT, BSOL & ETHA Price comparison 20th March – 1st May

i. Bitcoin and ETHA Price Comparison

Towards the end of March, Bitcoin faced "risk-off" momentum, entering a phase of consolidation as such profit-taking traders closed positions (Cryptal, 2026). Figure 14 shows that this is not a negative trend but a market adjustment period to help establish stable price levels. Overall, in March, Bitcoin had a marginal +1.83% gain, while Ethereum advanced +7.14%, indicating capital rotation (Gupta, 2026). The reason behind this is that staking-enabled ETFs, such as BlackRock's ETHB launching in early 2026, anticipated a 19-day inflow streak. BlackRock's iShares Ethereum Trust (ETHA) is the dominant product with over $6.5 billion in AUM and cumulative inflows exceeding $11.9 billion (Dan, 2026). Geopolitical uncertainty also spiked with escalation in Lebanon, Iran and Israel on the 23rd of March (CNN, 2026). Figure 17 shows consistent net inflows, reinforcing that institutional demand remained resilient. However, despite the ongoing US- Middle East tensions, the ETFs' price rise indicates a divergence from safe-have asset but a wider trend of non-fiat dollarisation.

ii. Non-fiat Dollarisation

The transition to defiatisation framework is consistent with plotting the US Dollar Index (DXY) and the US 2Yr Government Bond Yield from Figures 15-16. In April, the Dollar index declined, with a -0.90 30-day correlation coefficient with Bitcoin (Campisi, 2026). This is consistent with empirical findings that BTC exhibits strong negative sensitivity to dollar strength cycles (Baur et al., 2021). Additionally, the flattening of short-term government bond yields reflects expectations of tighter monetary policy, particularly potential Federal Reserve rate hikes (Chen, 2025). This reduces the attractiveness of existing lower-yielding assets and may incentivise investors to see alternative assets. Together, these dynamics provide supporting evidence for a gradual shift towards decentralised financial assets. Moreover, holding digital "dollar" backed assets like IBIT and ETHA is favourable due to their decentralised and accessible nature. According to the Japan Times (2026), in April, Iran took payments in stablecoins and Chinese yuan at its Strait of Hormuz tollbooths for commercial shipping. This signals the marginal erosion of USD settlement demand in global energy corridors.

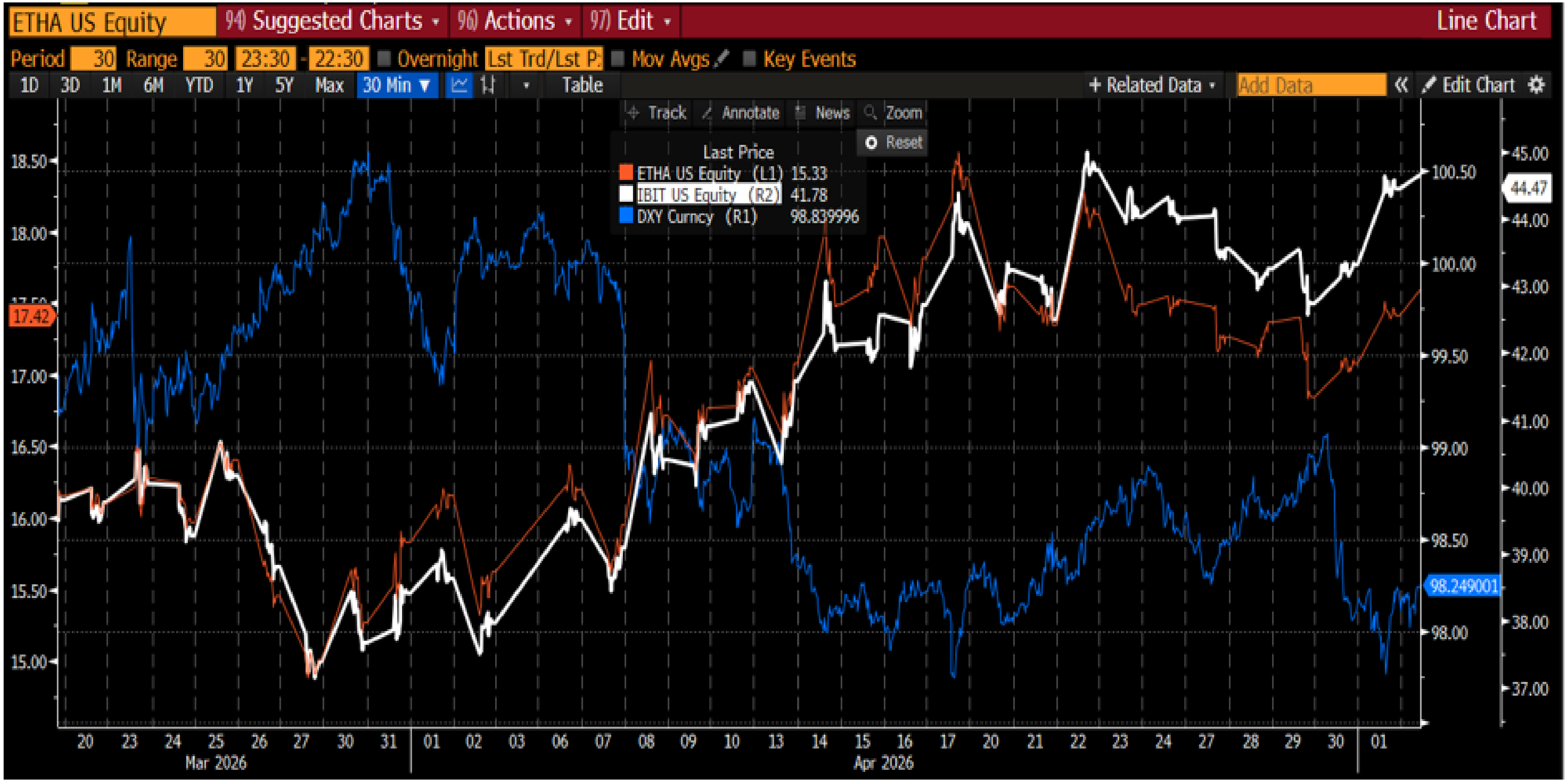

Figure 18: IBIT and ETHA price comparison with the US Dollar Index (DXY)

Figure 19IBIT and ETHA price comparison with the 2-Yr Generic Government Bond Yield (USGG2YR) Index

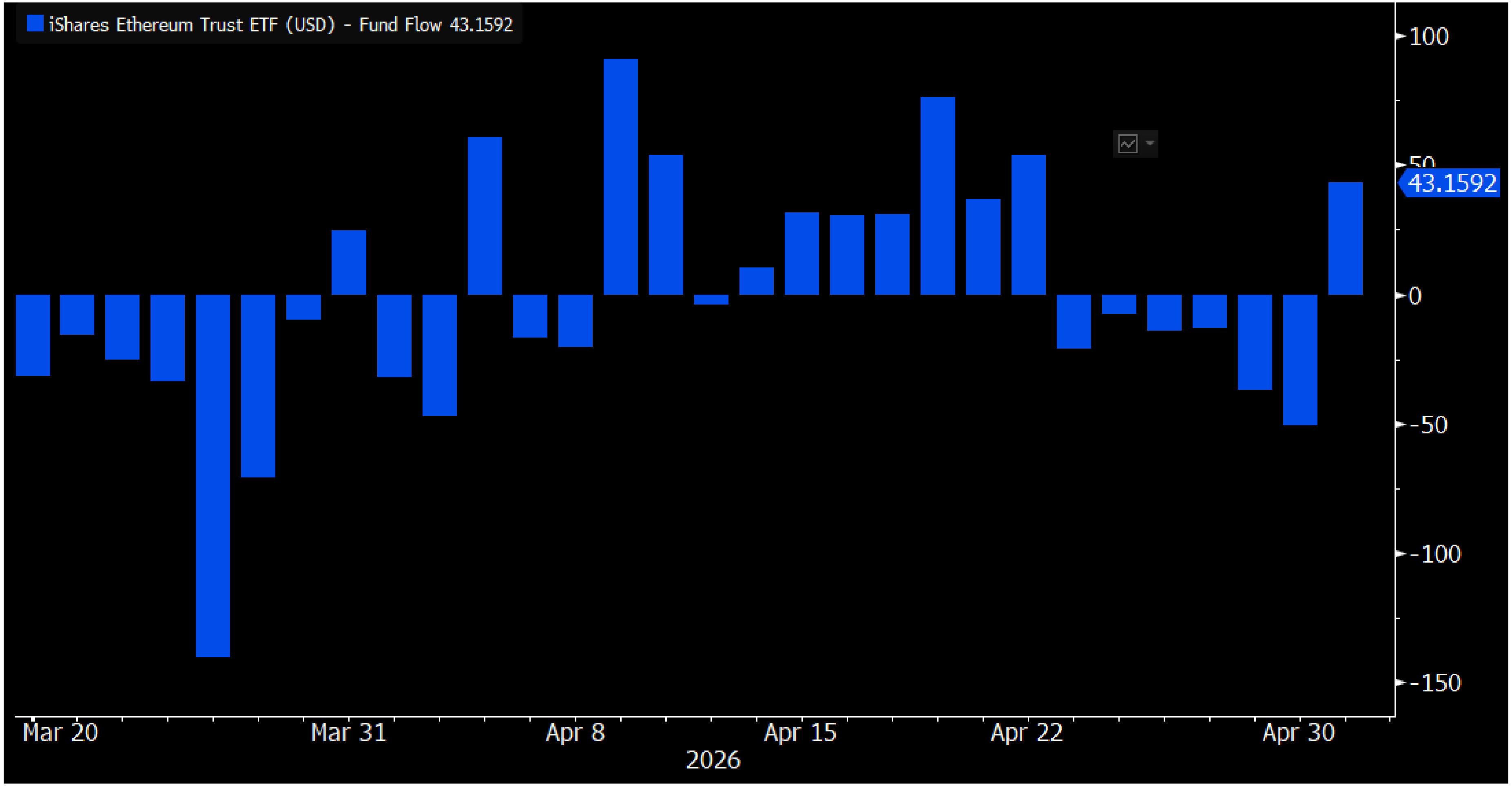

Figure 20: ETHA Flows Chart

ii. Stablecoins and Dollarisation

Stablecoins rely on Ethereum's ERC-20 infrastructure (Malinova and Park, 2026). Stablecoin expansion significantly accelerated the digital dollarisation (See Figures 18 & 19). The USDT supply rose by over $5B in April (Tether, 2026), USDC expanded 20% on Solana (Gomez, 2026), and the broader market reached $318.6B. These inflows reflect growing global demand for dollar liquidity outside banking rails, especially after events such as Tether freezing $344M stablecoins linked to Iran and Circle launching near-instant cross-chain settlement (Gomez, 2026; Mary, 2026). Furthermore, Tether posted $1.948B Q1 profits and record $8.23B reserves, reinforcing its role as a major driver of global digital dollar (Tether, 2026). Figure 20 shows a sharp rise in USDT transfer volumes and transaction counts through April, indicating a heightening of on-chain dollar liquidity. On 19th April, AAVE and KelpDAO exploit triggered $6.6Bn in stablecoin outflows, causing a late ETHA dip (PANews, 2026), allowing IBIT to temporarily outperform. Yet despite these fluctuations, the structural direction remains unchanged; global capital is steadily migrating towards non-fiat dollarisation through stablecoins and crypto-denominated USD proxies.

Figure 21: USDC Price Chart   Source: Coingecko, 2026

Figure 22: USDT – Tether Price   Source: Coingecko, 2026

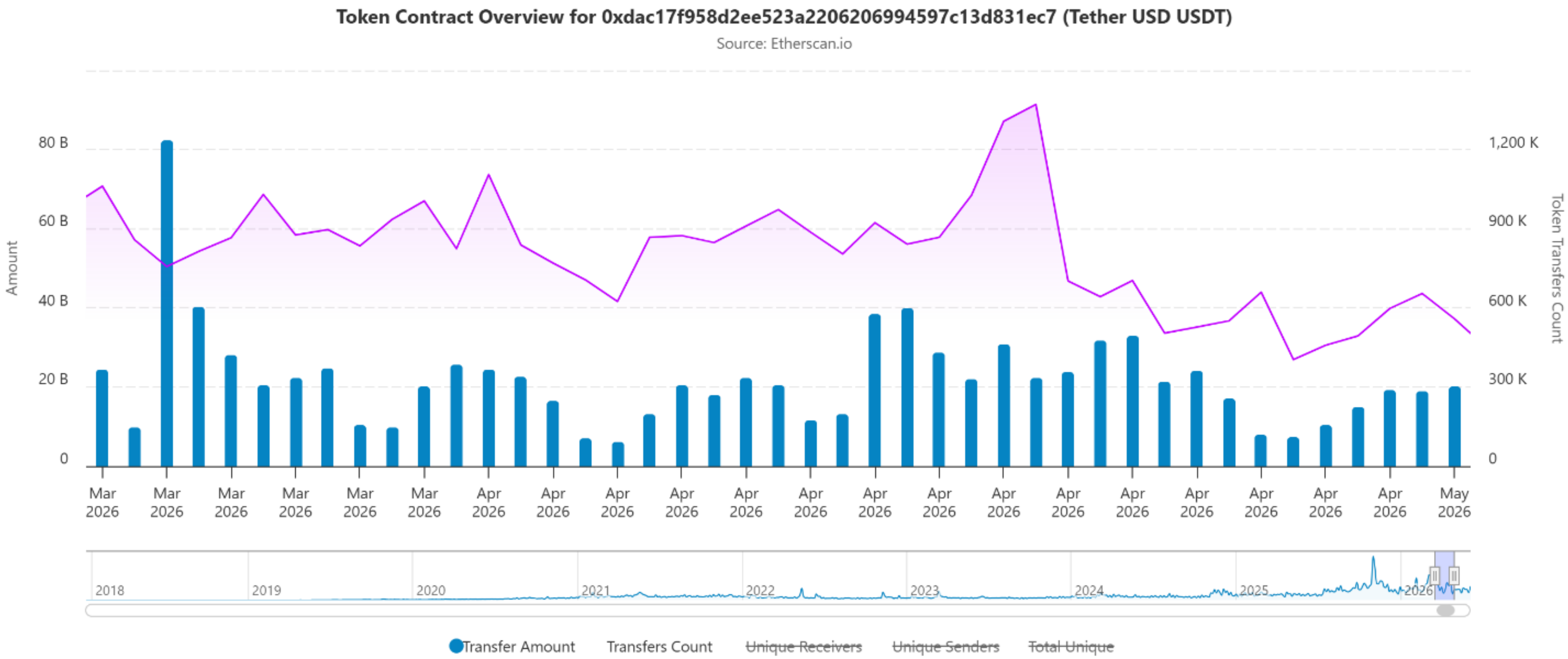

Figure 23: Daily Transfer Amounts and Frequency of Tether (USDCT) Source: Etherscan.io

ETFs Price Movement 1st -15th May

Portfolio

			Current						Cost				
Security	ID	Position	Price	PCS	FX Rate	Principal	Accrued	Market Val	Price	FX Rate	Principal	Accrued	Cost Val
<Search>													
Totals						174,597,000.00	0.00	174,597,000.00			173,030,500.00	0.00	173,030,500
Cash		0.0000											
BSOL US	BSOL	4,600,000.(	12.05	EXCH	1.00000	55,430,000.00		55,430,000.00	11.31	1.00000	52,026,000.00		52,026,000.(
ETHA US	ETHA	3,500,000.(	16.76	EXCH	1.00000	58,660,000.00		58,660,000.00	17.42	1.00000	60,970,000.00		60,970,000.(
IBIT US	IBIT	1,350,000.(	44.82	EXCH	1.00000	60,507,000.00		60,507,000.00	44.47	1.00000	60,034,500.00		60,034,500.(

Figure 24: : ETF Portfolio from 1st – 15th May, increased from $173 million to $174.6 million, with IBIT ($60 million) outperforming

Figure 25: IBIT, BSOL and ETHA Price Movements

i. Bitcoin Price Movement

IBIT outperforms ETHA and BSOL in the first half of May (See Figure 22), due to the Bitcoin market experiencing a volatile but generally bullish recovery phase driven largely by institutional demand (Harper, 2026). Bitcoin hit $81,000 on May 5th, with ETF inflows totalling $2.44 billion (Crypto News, 2026; Figure 25). Moreover, the partial de-escalation in the ongoing US-Iran war (CNN, 2026) generally moved equities upwards with the S&P500 recovering its momentum (See Figure 23) and Crude Oil Prices also reducing (See Figure 24), indicating the market regaining confidence with stabilising macroeconomic indicators. This reflects a wider discourse of Bitcoin ETF-linked prices being sensitive to macroeconomic forces. Pourpourides (2025) demonstrates that Bitcoin has a negative sensitivity to dollar strength, and gold suggests that Bitcoin behaves as a risk-aligned macro asset, with ETH flows responding directly to shifts in global liquidity, geopolitical risk and monetary expectations.

This evolving behaviour reflects the financialization of crypto, whereby Bitcoin is no longer a primary value for its decentralised, digital gold or non-fiat characteristics, but is instead priced through the same mechanisms as traditional financial instruments like equities (Arner et al, 2024). Furthermore, the tokenisation trend highlighted by Banerjee et al. (2024) shows that financial institutions are rapidly integrating block-based assets. This expansion naturally increases institutional participation in Bitcoin ETFs, embedding Bitcoin within the same ecosystem of intermediaries, collateral flows, and balance-sheet dynamics that govern traditional markets (Arner et al, 2024). Similarly, Corbet et al (2019) and Baur and Dimpfl (2018) suggest that Bitcoin's return dynamics increasingly resemble those of financialised assets, exhibiting behaviours which alternate between safe-haven characteristics and risk-correlated performance depending on macroeconomic indicators.

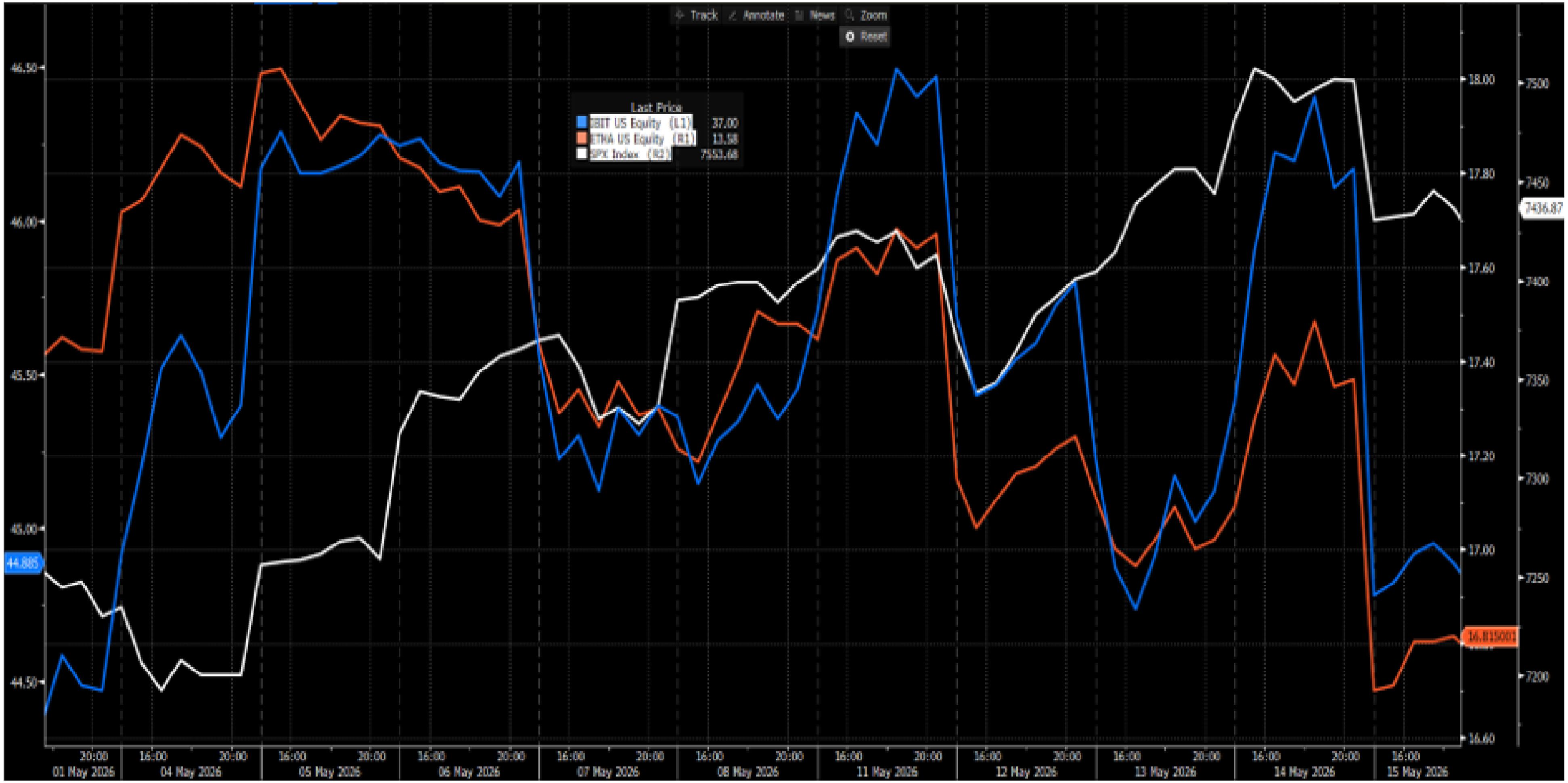

Figure 26: IBIT, ETHA comparison with the S&P500 Index

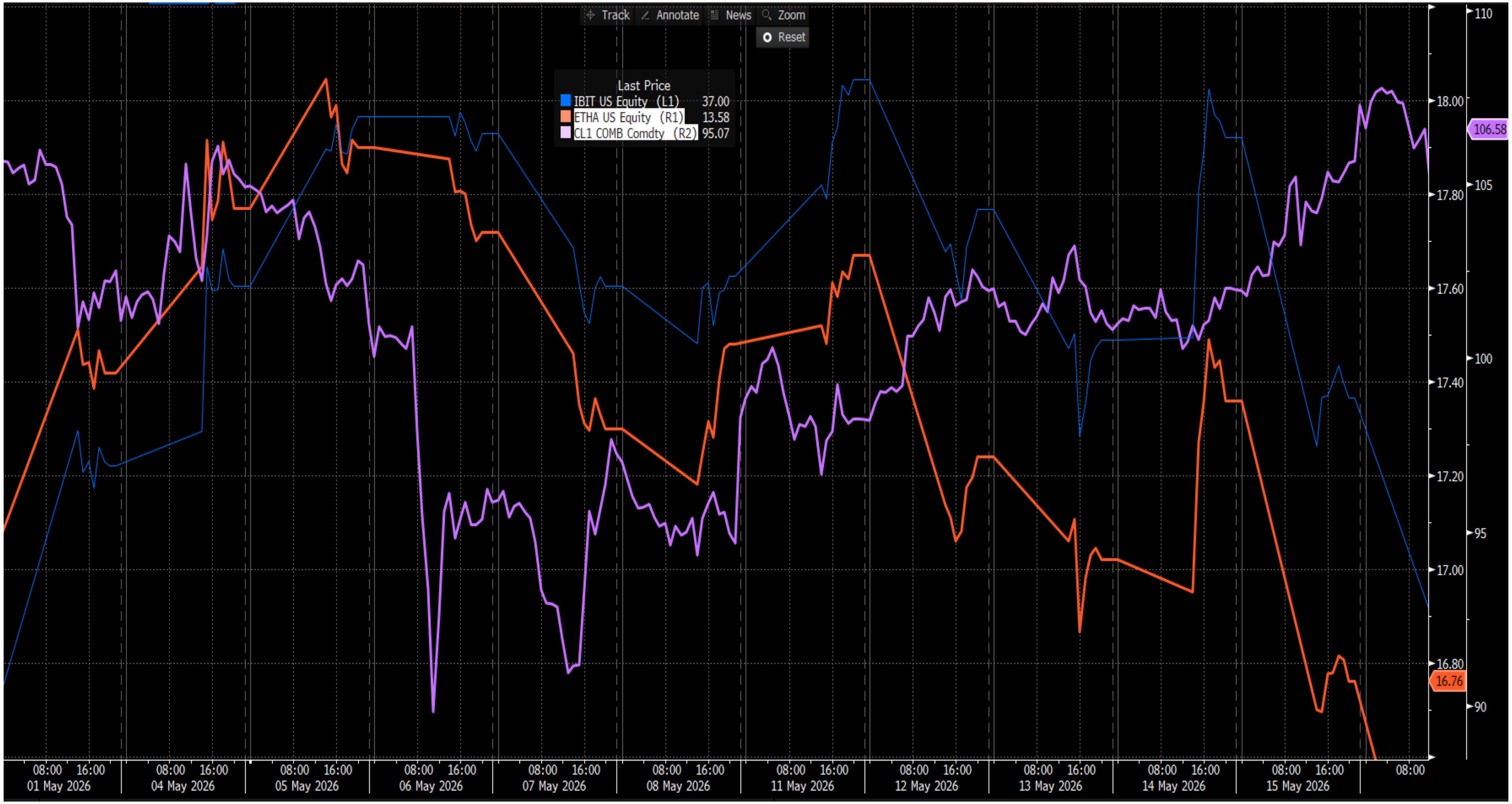

Figure 27: ETHA and IBIT comparison with Crude Oil Prices USD

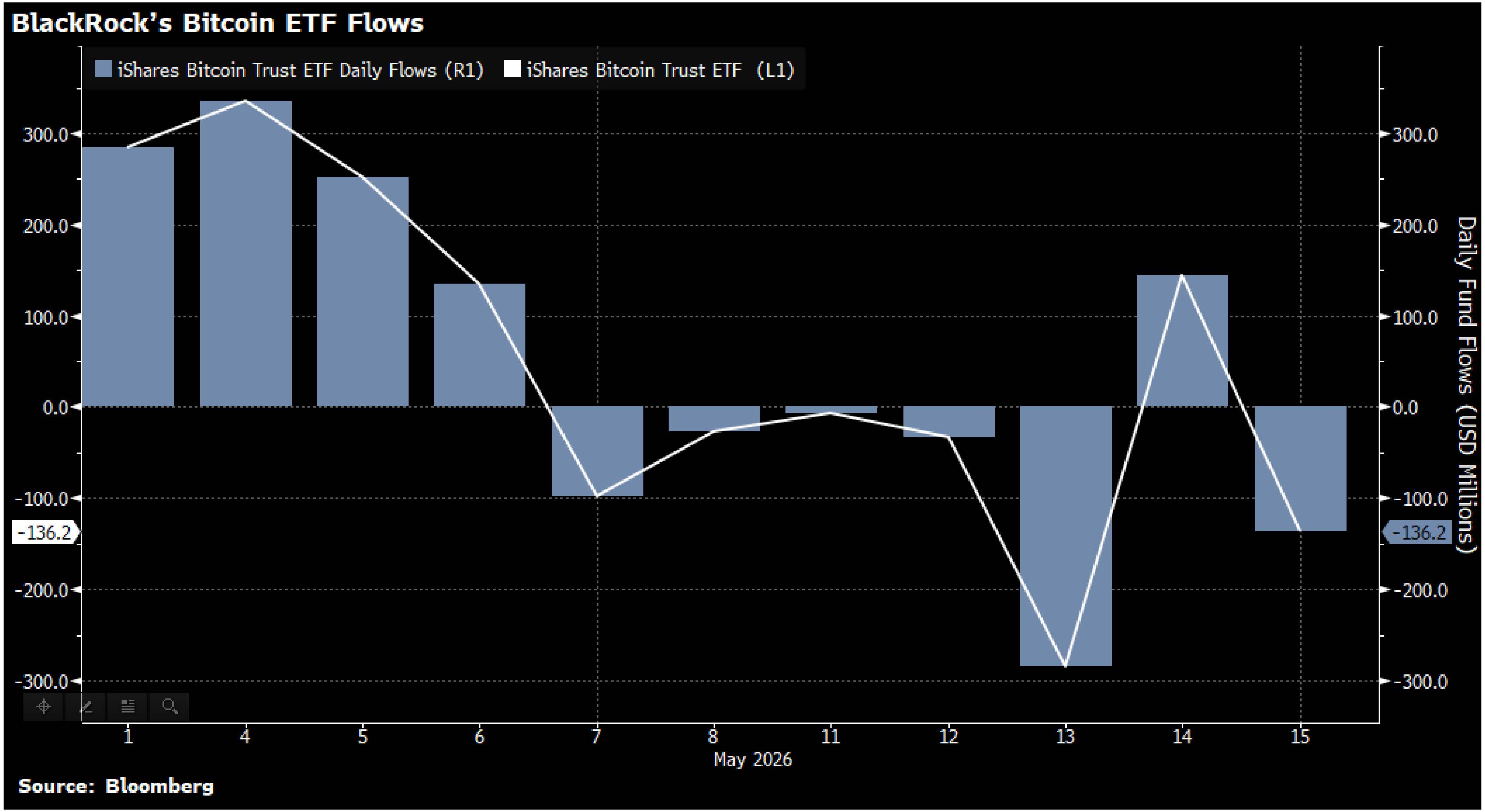

Figure 28: IBIT Net Flows Chart

ii. ETHA and BSOL Price Movements

In contrast to IBIT, ETHA underperformed in the first half of May, despite meaningful institutional tailwinds. As illustrated by Figure 26, spot Ethereum ETFs reversed a six-month negative streak with” $356 million in net inflows in April 2026, led by BlackRock and Fidelity, with ETHA recording $101.2 million on May 1st alone” (MEXC, 2026). “BlackRock's staked ETH ETF additionally attracted $100 million on its first day of trading, reducing exchange-held ETH supply to a yearly low of 14.9 million ETH” (MEXC, 2026). However, despite these institutional inflows, ETHA remained capped below the $2,400 resistance level throughout the period, reflecting broader macro consolidation (Daodu, 2026).

The underperformance of ETHA relative to IBIT is consistent with the financialization thesis of Corbet et al. (2019), whereby during periods of stabilising macroeconomic sentiment, capital rotates back toward Bitcoin ETFs as the primary institutional-grade digital asset. Ethereum's structural upside remains anchored to the upcoming Glamsterdam upgrade, targeting June 2026, which could triple Layer 1 throughput through parallel execution (MEXC, 2026). Figure 27 shows Ethereum daily transactions remaining stable throughout the period, indicating that network utility did not drive price appreciation.

BSOL continued to underperform both IBIT and ETHA, consistent with the pattern identified in the second diary period. With Solana network fees remaining subdued, BSOL continued to exhibit high-beta speculative behaviour rather than defensive institutional characteristics, reinforcing its vulnerability during periods of broader market uncertainty (ECB, 2023).

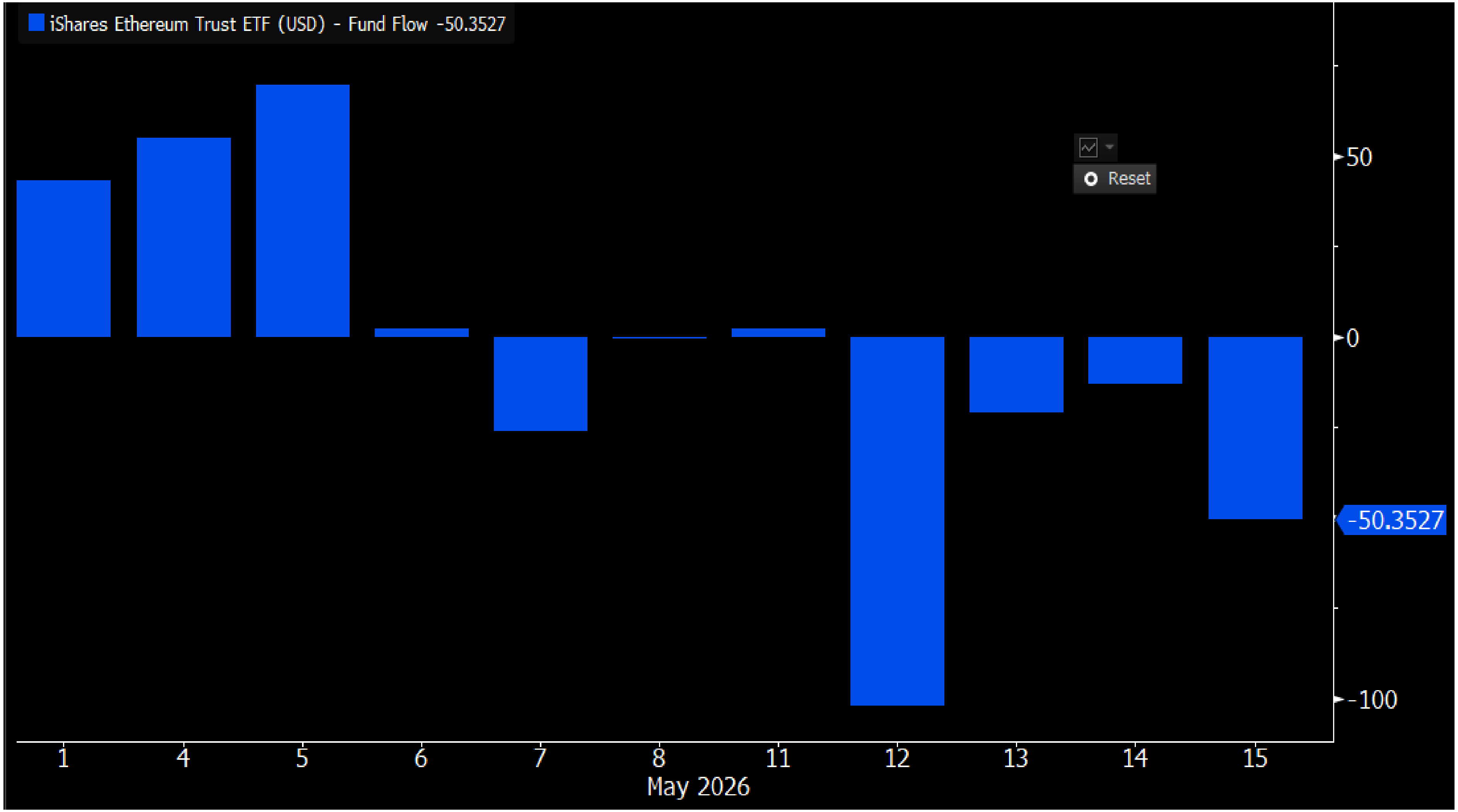

Figure 29: ETHA Net Flows Chart

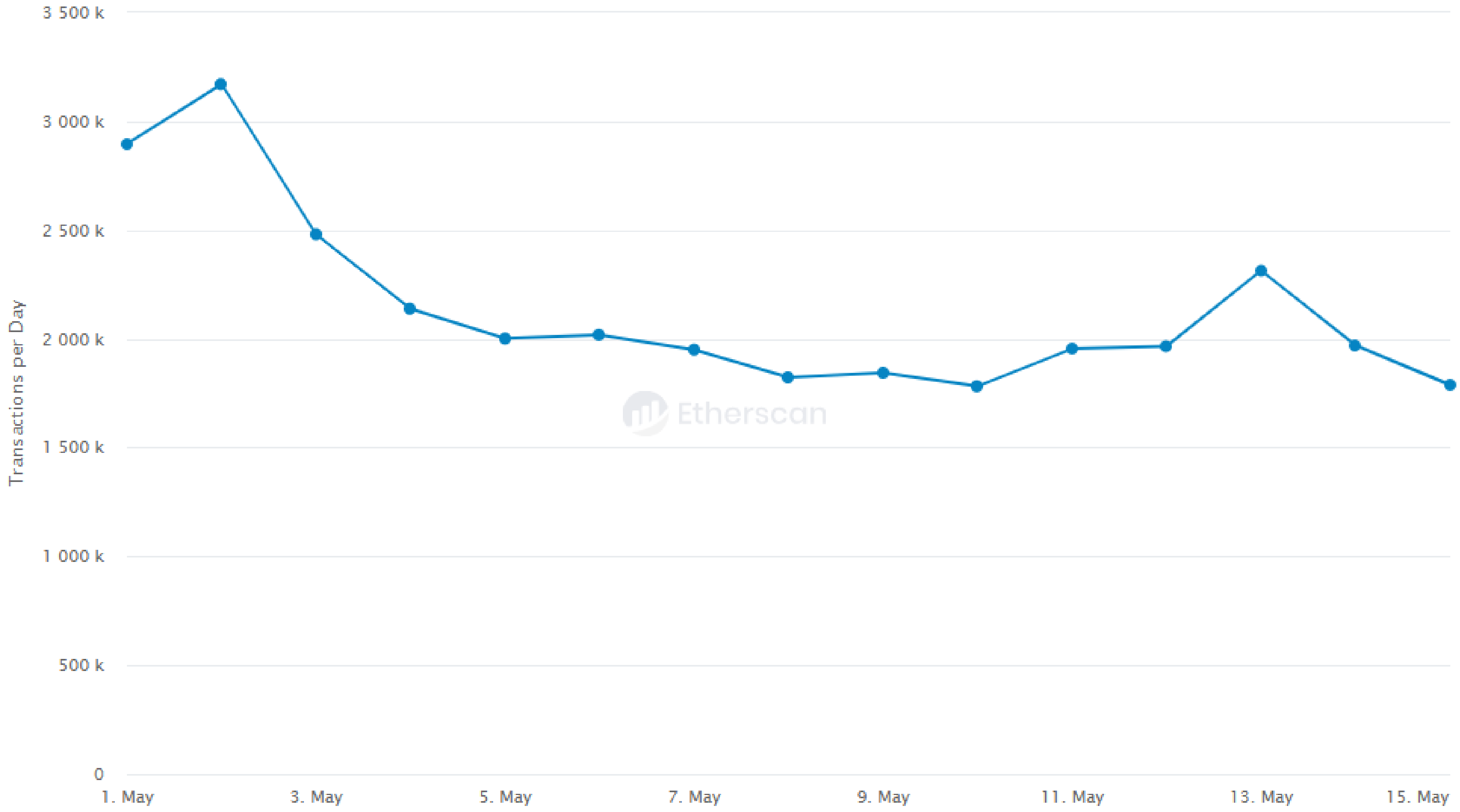

Figure 30: Ethereum Transactions Per Day   Source: Etherescan.i

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